

Wesley Kay

Design Lead · Design Systems, Foundations, AI Enablement [Portfolio](#) · [LinkedIn](#) ·

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SUMMARY

Product designer with 8+ years building the foundations other teams build on. Built Qualcomm's first design system from scratch (taxonomy, 1,500+ icons, governance, documentation architecture) and shaped the strategy for an **AI-consumable design system** at BNY, where a regulated bank's AI platform is starting to generate its own UI. My position: a design system for a generator is a set of rules the generator obeys, enforced in code, not documentation humans are asked to read. I build the enablement tooling to match, including an automated design audit that files inconsistencies as issues. Co-founded a venture-backed DeFi protocol (0→100K+ users, \$4M seed) where I owned the whole design language. Architecture-trained systems thinker who works **Claude → working code** and ships with engineers in shared repos.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior (Staff) AI Designer

BNY (Contract) · Oct 2025–Present

Design lead for the core experience of **Eliza**, BNY's enterprise internal AI platform serving 40K employees bank-wide: the app through which the bank's employees meet AI. Working in genuinely greenfield space across a portfolio of agent-driven products.

- **Shaped strategy for an AI-consumable design system.** Bent in-flight teams off legacy approaches and pushed component strategy toward LLM-friendly architecture: larger semantic components with clear usage contracts instead of highly compositional Swiss Army knife patterns. Surfaced where traditional design systems break down for AI-driven UI: the system's job becomes enforcement, rules an agent obeys and code checks (lint, tests, deterministic fixes), not prose a human is asked to read.
- **Built an automated design audit tool** that screenshots design inconsistencies and files them as issue-tracker entries, force-multiplying QA for the whole team. Shipped it alongside Eliza's light mode (3 days end-to-end, A11Y-compliant palettes).
- **Defined two platform frameworks that were adopted.** A placement framework for where new AI products live (Eliza-native, integrated, external) and a task model (self-created, assigned, AI-proposed) that gives AI-proposed work a different trust level than assigned work. Validated both through 1:1 user testing.
- **Owned end-to-end** the global navigation and landing-page redesign of Eliza for its March 2026 launch: unified information architecture across every Eliza app, left-hand navigation library, and a new hub landing page that became the front door to the bank's AI surface area. The global navigation shipped to production bank-wide in July 2026.
- **Turned a notifications requirement into a work-management model.** Work reached users from colleagues, systems, and AI across separate surfaces with no shared sense of priority. Built a criticality and triage model on top of the task model, and set the vision for converging planner, tasks, and notifications into one experience. Now validating it with a research framework I built that maps personas against work styles.
- **Designing the assistant's interaction layer.** Queued and concurrent prompts, context-window visibility, model selection, and discoverability and output design for assistant actions across email, calendar, chat, and documents. Deliver production-candidate prototypes and partner with engineering on release scope.

- **Owned end-to-end UX for the agent marketplace.** A self-service interface for staff to deploy AI agents. Defined the underlying **data model**, the **filtering and integration surfaces**, and the deployment pathways for getting new agents into the marketplace.
- **Ran independent research on the Eliza nav redesign.** Interviewed Eliza users 1-on-1 about what they needed, fed transcripts through an agent I built to synthesize findings, then designed off the synthesis. No research process was handed to me; I built the loop.
- **Work upstream of the canvas.** Five prototype iterations in a single session, design-to-engineer-ready in hours instead of weeks. Team is months ahead of peer design groups on AI tool adoption.

Senior (Staff) Product Designer · Design Systems Lead

Qualcomm (Contract) · Feb 2025–Sept 2025

- **Set the visual direction and wrote the design principles the team built from,** then defined what a UX pattern *is* for Qualcomm's first design system and which ones it would ship. Ran original research (interviews with three staff designers + a Head of Design), benchmarked peer systems (Carbon, Material, Polaris, Atlassian), and built a taxonomy I tested against current and future products. Presented to Heads of Design and got buy-in on the framework before the pattern library roadmap was committed.
- **Built an AI-in-the-loop documentation workflow from scratch.** Reduced writing effort 120x and CMS page creation 95%, enabling the team to ship 60+ component documents on schedule for the system's enterprise beta launch.
- **Built a 1,500+ icon system** across multiple categories (sizing standards, naming conventions, maintenance workflows) that unified marketing and product design under one taxonomy.
- **Owned the design system documentation architecture** end-to-end, including governance, contribution processes, and review workflows for a distributed team across multiple time zones.
- **Pioneered cross-team alignment** between marketing, engineering, and design, translating brand guidelines into actionable product standards.

Co-Founder, Designer

Autonomy / Overlay · Feb 2021–Feb 2025

- **Took a DeFi protocol from zero to one** as co-founder and head of design. Owned the entire design language: UX, UI, brand, and interaction across web app, mobile, and marketing, held together by a written manifesto. Community grew 0 → **100K+** (77K Twitter, 50K Discord).
- **Built a remote cross-functional team from 3 to 25**, establishing hiring, onboarding, design reviews, and remote work operating model.
- **Shipped 12 new products** including referrals, staking, and gamification features, informed by user research and measured by adoption.
- **Established protocol governance model** for changes across business units; navigated regulatory requirements across 4 international jurisdictions.
- **Managed \$3.4M budget** and investor relationships through a \$4M seed round.

Principal Designer, Founder

Field Design Co. · Jun 2023–Feb 2025

- Unlimited design subscription for early-stage startups. Helped 2x sales for a client via UX improvements; mentored team members and implemented a process that cut iteration cycles 25–35%.

Senior UX Designer, Lead

T-Mobile · Feb 2020–Sept 2021

- **Design Lead for Search.** Reduced null results 94%, increased engagement 105%, increased buying intention 661%.
- **Design Lead for Navigation.** Designed the framework used by **40M+ monthly active users** across web and mobile.
- **Led research initiatives end-to-end.** Defined research questions, briefed the in-house research team and third-party vendors on methodology, translated findings into product direction. Owned the discovery side, not just the design side.
- **Co-led a cross-functional team** of PMs, researchers, and design leads; contributed components to the design system serving 40+ designers.

Earlier

UI/UX Designer at Opolis (blockchain employment ecosystem, dual PM responsibilities, 2018–2019). UI/UX consulting at Toptender (2019). Volunteer with Circles UBI (2018).

SELECTED SIDE PROJECTS

sketch-to-revit (2026)

0→1 AI tool that turns a set of hand-drawn architectural sketches (plans, elevations, sections, perspectives, parti) into a single multi-storey IFC BIM model openable in Revit or ArchiCAD. Multi-image vision reconciliation in one Claude call, structured output, IFC geometry generated programmatically. Solo design + build, in alpha testing with an architect.

Iona Tracker (2026)

Self-hosted PWA for tracking newborn and toddler activity across caregivers: feeds, sleep, handoffs. Solo design + build (Node, Express, SQLite, Cloudflare Tunnel, Mac mini host). Running daily in my own home.

EDUCATION

Master of Architecture: University of Colorado Denver, 2014–2017 **B.A. Environmental Studies, cum laude:** University of Colorado Boulder, 2008–2010

SKILLS

Design Systems: Component contracts, tokens, governance, AI-consumable foundations, multi-product scaling **AI Experience Design:** Agentic UX patterns, conversational interfaces, AI-proposed work and triage, multi-prompt and context-window UX, AI-assisted discovery and intake, prompt design, design for governance and oversight **AI-Native Workflow:** MCP, shared-repo collaboration with engineers, prompt-driven prototyping, vibe coding **Systems Design:** Data models, permissions, integration surfaces, information architecture, multi-product taxonomies that compound **Product Design:** Zero-to-one greenfield, end-to-end domain ownership, dashboards, executive-level stakeholder alignment **User Research:** Independent qualitative research, interview synthesis, translating ambiguous needs into product direction **Tools:** Claude, Cursor, Windsurf, MCP, Git/GitLab, HTML/CSS, Figma, Framer, Sketch, Adobe Suite